John Mahood School Council

Meeting Minutes May 31st, 2023

Location: School Library

Present:

In Person:

Kristen Dorscht
Robyn Shoemaker
Christine Martin
Emily McConnell
Catherine Hibbard
Bethany Metzger
Jennie McGovern
Kandis Walker
Kacheena Morrison
Sarah Pollice
Natalie Anglin
Stephanie Rempel
Chyenne Vautour
Mary Blanchard
Laura Fehrenbach

Territorial Acknowledgement - Pam

Discussion of Previous Minutes - Kristen/Stephanie

- See last month's minutes here
    - Motion to Approve - Kristen
    - Accepted by -Jennie
    - Seconded by - Stephanie

Principal's Report - Pam

- Jungle sport report
    - $4,000+ out of principal budget
    - Very successful event, every class got to go twice
    - Feedback from the kids was very positive
    - May not be able to afford to do it every year but was worth it, especially post-covid when it was put on hold
    - They change the setup for different grades
- End of year
    - Very busy, lots of everything, some kids are feeling done
    - 416 students for next year
    - 3.5 kindergarten classes next year. Half class capped at 15 students with no DECE.
    - All junior classes are at 29 next year
    - All primary classes are at cap
    - Reading resource teacher assigned to our school next year. Will change the spec ed model, Mary Janzen will be taking that roll
    - French Immersion 4-5 class moving from portable into the school next year
    - Losing a portable next year since one class was dropped
- New sound system - Thankyou!
    - Coming from Long & McQuade next week
    - Cost will be just over $1800, ($2500 was approved by council)

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- Pam expressed her Thanks and gratitude for school council. She appreciated that it was a great year and was positive and very collaborative
- Thoughts for September
    - Planners for grades 2-3 and up for next year
    - $5 per student (approx), funding to be determined, whether it be by families, or council
- Pride Month starts tomorrow, rainbow day June 1
    - Focus on acceptance and inclusion for everyone. Very age appropriate
    - Bulletin board theme is focused on Pride, has all of the different pride flags
- Grade 6 Camp Schedule
    - Nature hike, disc golf, archery, gaga ball and more - sounds like lots of fun!
- Spirit Day June 12th, each class to wear a different colour, will be doing a large arial school picture outside with all of the kids in a rainbow
- Jump Rope for Heart - June 15th. Rain date June 16th
    - More information to be firmed up, communication to follow
- Primary play day - nothing planned as of yet
- Turtle Island June 12th
- Picnic table has been delivered, needs to be put together

Chair's Report - Kristen/Stephanie

- Last few school council T-shirts have arrived
- Maple syrup festival grant
    - Looking for something to go to the grant giving ceremony on June 14th at 7m
    - Heads up from Jennie, they will likely ask for a little blurb about what the funds will be used for.

Treasury Report - Renee

- No change to recorded balances since month-end has not closed. Estimated balances are the same as what was sent on May 17th

Estimated cash balances available as of April 30, 2023	**8,335**
Received Lion's Club Bingo cheque	915
Approved Freezies for Jump Rope for Heart	(125)
Approved Grade 6 celebration	(250)
Pending Sound system	(2,500)
Pending Grade 6 camp	(1,000)
Estimated cash balances	**5,375**

    - The above totals include MahoodFest expenditures, but not revenue

- Next year proposed purchase of new walkie-talkies $400ea for the same style they use now ($500-700 for the board approved model)
- For Turtle Island event, Renee asked if after the Pro Grant money is used that the remaining cost be spend out of the PIC money before dipping into council funds
    - PIC money was allocated for Kindie night, which is spent
    - Could funds from Maple syrup grant be used to cover extra?

Fundraising & Community Events Sub-Committee - Kristen

- Turtle Island Riverside joint event update
    - 6:30pm at the Riverside gymnasium
    - Looking forward to a good event
- Mahoodfest Update
    - June 20th, starts at 5pm
    - Lots of planning ongoing
    - General things for people to know
        - Tickets went on sale this week, can be purchased on school day
        - Tickets can be purchased with cash at the event
        - Raffle basket donations are coming in - slowly. Reminder to get your donations in, reminder to go out on school day
        - If wanting to donate money towards the basket, send the money to the office in an envelope with your child
        - Today is the last day for volunteer sign-ups
            - Could be short volunteers in the 6-7pm time slot
        - Working on a map for the event
        - Leanne asked that any money coming in is brought to the office throughout the evening, instead of all at the end of the night
        - Pam asked if we could provide daily announcement to generate excitement for the kids (and remind them to donate to raffle)
- Idea - Factory Shoe Fundraiser - Laura
    - Any purchase of a pair of shoes over the cost of $30 is eligible. $5 from each pair purchased goes back to school
    - Idea is to set up fundraiser before school ends, to take advantage of summer back to school shopping
    - Laura to take the lead on setting up the fundraiser
    - **Motion to set up new fundraiser before school end to take advantage of summer back to school shopping - Kristen**
        - **Passed by majority vote**

Open Discussion - All

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- Pitas - Pam
    - Grade sixes help deliver the Pitas
    - Was done through the general fund this year, not through school council
    - Was supposed to get $0.50 per pita. Final total was $1500 (worked out to $1 per pita)
    - Would like to have this fundraising initiative go towards school events
    - This year the money went towards the grade 6 trip
    - There was confusion about whether the funds would be handled by school council or school office - Next year the handling of Pitas and finances will go through the office general funds
- Gaga Ball pit
    - Emily proposed to keep the ball rolling on this before year end. Since council already approved $1500, and we have funds available to cover the remaining costs (approx $7500 total)
    - Doing so could put our balance almost to zero
    - It is nice to see the fundraising money being used, rather than being carried forward from year to year, especially for families who graduate out after contributing fundraising dollars
    - Pam to get us final quote numbers so we know exactly what we need to vote on, if we want to get this pushed through this year
    - Likely to follow up with a vote via email
- Idea for next year - Jennie
    - Harvey's burger day
    - Her school does it once per month
    - Very easy, all burgers are the exact same
    - More affordable
    - Kids love it!

- Social Media
    - Very busy, posting lots, generating excitement for Mahoodfest
    - No negative responses
    - Still not a lot of engagement

- First meeting next year
    - The first meeting next year will be the last meeting for this years members, after which nominations/applications will take place to establish the new school year council
    - Second meeting
        - Elections - need to be within first 30 days of school year

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Next meeting

- September 27th 2023, 7pm

Additional discussion / activities after the meeting

- Email from Kristen on June 6th
  - Two spending overages that require a vote;
  - Final cost of the new proctor was $15.19 higher than previously voted on
    - **Motion to approve projector overage - Kristen**
    - **Passed by majority vote**
  - Vision of Turtle Island event is $109.49 higher than the PRO grant.
    - **Motion to approve $109.49 out of council funds for event - Kristen**
    - **Passed by majority vote**
- Email from Stephanie on Thursday June 15th
  - Pam and staff have come up with the final quote for the gaga ball pit. The final quote is $5819.50 including HST. Council previously approved $1500, so $4319.50 would need to be voted on for the project to go forward, and to be installed before next fall
    - Background information. The previously approved $1000 for the grade 6 trip was not used (Pita pit money was used instead) so that $1000 is still available in the council account.
    - **Motion to approve $4319.50 in additional spending towards the Gaga Ball Pit - Stephanie**
    - **Vote Y/N**
- Email from Kristen on Thursday June 15th
  - A council member has requested that council cover the cost of bussing for the selected Grade 4-6 students to attend the district track and field meet next week. Cost of bussing is $644.
    - Note that permission forms and school day requests for parents to pay the $8 (I believe) have already gone out, but the office said they could refund any parents who have already paid (if the vote passes).
    - **Motion to approve $644 to cover the cost of bussing to the district Track and Field meet - Kristen**
    - **Not Passed**